

TAK WING YU

PhD, MSc, BSc (Hons) Physiotherapy

Senior Lecturer in Physiotherapy | Saint Francis University, Hong Kong

Educational development, assessment, AI, VR and simulation

Public academic CV | Updated 4 October 2026

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Award-winning Senior Lecturer and health professions education researcher with more than 10 years of tertiary and clinical education experience in Hong Kong and South Africa. I combine programme coordination and assessment quality assurance with practical implementation of generative AI, VR/XR and simulation. My PhD used design-based research to develop guidance for implementing VR in health professions education. Through educator development, collaborative funded projects and evidence-informed evaluation, I translate educational needs into learning designs and implementation processes.

CURRENT ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT & LEADERSHIP

Senior Lecturer in Physiotherapy | Saint Francis University, Hong Kong | Apr 2024 - Present

Coordinate and deliver undergraduate learning across foundational science, movement science, health technology and clinical/professional areas, connecting learning outcomes, teaching activities and assessment.

Serve as Year 1 Head Teacher, supporting cohort transition, mentoring, induction, teaching-plan coordination and programme-level student support.

Lead and contribute to internal moderation and assessment quality assurance: develop rubrics and cases, coordinate moderators, support continuous and summative assessment planning, and contribute to marksheet processes and practical/OSPE assessment.

Coordinate with colleagues on programme-wide teaching plans and curriculum alignment across four BSc Physiotherapy year levels, following through on implementation and access issues.

Develop and implement VR, AI, simulation and digital-assessment activities with attention to constructive alignment, learner safety, accessibility, responsible use and iterative evaluation.

Supervise Honours Research Projects and contribute to clinical-education development, curriculum review, outreach, final-year research support and programme administration.

Work with clinical educators and external partners to strengthen the academic-to-clinical transition and students' professional readiness.

EDUCATIONAL DEVELOPMENT & DIGITAL LEARNING PORTFOLIO

Responsible AI & Digital Learning

Designed Socratic AI-supported clinical-reasoning activities that require students to gather data, generate and evaluate hypotheses, justify decisions and reflect on reasoning rather than receive direct answers.

Developed assessment approaches combining AI-use disclosure, prompt/process documentation, oral defence and critical appraisal, requiring students to explain and take responsibility for AI-assisted work.

Implemented pseudonymised chatbot workflows in simulation and used learner interaction, performance and usage data to support evaluation and iterative improvement.

Immersive Learning, VR/XR & Simulation

Developed and implemented immersive and mobile VR learning across anatomy, health technology and procedural/clinical learning, using curriculum alignment, safety cues, structured practice and evaluation.

Developed an acupuncture VR sequence incorporating theory, training, practice, assessment, safety prompts and usage analytics to support continuous improvement.

Contribute to simulation-based education, including interprofessional nursing-physiotherapy simulation, airway-clearance/suctioning scenarios, standardised-patient work, pre-briefing/debriefing and practice-readiness activities.

PhD developed evidence-informed guiding principles for VR implementation in health professions education using design-based research.

Curriculum, Assessment & Quality Enhancement

Apply constructive alignment, curriculum review, learning-outcome mapping and assessment redesign in undergraduate health-science education in Hong Kong.

Design and moderation of case-based assessments, rubrics, practical examinations and OSPE-style activities, with emphasis on reliability, transparency, feedback/feedforward and academic integrity.

Use student feedback, implementation evidence and learner-usage data to identify issues and inform quality enhancement; distinguish engagement measures from demonstrated learning outcomes.

Educator Development & Stakeholder Engagement

Invited Learning and Teaching presentation (14 Sep 2026): "Transforming Physiotherapy Education with the use of AI, VR and Simulation."

Invited Clinical Educator Training Programme presentation (28 Aug 2026): "Transforming Physiotherapy Education through Innovative Teaching Pedagogies."

Overseas Visiting Lecturer / clinical-placement engagement in Canada (Apr-May 2026), supporting international clinical-education exchange and partnership activity.

Collaborate with internal colleagues, clinical educators, external partners and international researchers across physiotherapy, nursing, simulation, AI and health professions education.

FUNDED EDUCATIONAL DEVELOPMENT & RESEARCH PROJECTS

2026 | Co-Investigator | HK\$194,000 - SFU Institutional Development Grant IDG250204: Enhancing Learning and Clinical Practicum Readiness Through Peer Patient and Peer Debrief Roles in Physiotherapy Simulation-based Learning: A Mixed-Methods Evaluation.

2026-2028 | Co-Investigator | HK\$145,800 - SFU Institutional Development Grant IDG250202: Effectiveness of an Interprofessional Education (IPE) Simulation Program for Undergraduate Students of Nursing and Physiotherapy. Human Research Ethics approval HRE250209 granted.

2022-2024 | Co-Investigator | R50,000 - Exploring the Perceptions of Health Professional Students During the COVID-19 Pandemic.

QUALIFICATIONS, AWARDS & PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

PhD in Physiotherapy, University of the Western Cape, South Africa - 2026. Thesis: Development of guiding principles for the use of Virtual Reality (VR) to support teaching and learning for health professions students.

MSc in Physiotherapy, University of the Western Cape, South Africa - 2017.

BSc (Hons) in Physiotherapy, University of the Western Cape, South Africa - 2013.

Teaching Excellence Award, Saint Francis University - 2026.

Registered Physiotherapist - Physiotherapists Board of Hong Kong; Health and Care Professions Council, United Kingdom; Health Professions Council of South Africa.

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC & CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Clinical Supervisor and Lecturer | University of the Western Cape, South Africa | Dec 2015 - Dec 2023

Delivered physiotherapy and health-professions teaching, supervised clinical placements and contributed to curriculum delivery, programme administration, technology-enhanced learning and educational scholarship.

Earlier clinical practice: Part-time Physiotherapist, Intercare Sub-Acute Hospital (2015-2017); Physiotherapist, Tygerberg Hospital (2014).

SELECTED SCHOLARSHIP & PUBLICATIONS

Yu TW, Rowe M, Frantz J. (2026). Virtual reality in health professions education: Qualitative descriptive study of educators' perspectives. JMIR XR and Spatial Computing, 3, e52925.

Williams T-L, Boggenpoel B, Hess D, Steyl T, Gamiet S, Madasa V, Yu TW, Mlenzana N, Karachi F, Phillips J. (2026). Exploring physiotherapy students' clinical experiences during educational disruption, through a community of practice lens. Health SA Gesondheid. <https://doi.org/10.4102/HSAG.v31i0.3286>.

Yu TW, Frantz J, Rowe M. (2024). Perceptions of health professions students on the use of immersive virtual reality. *African Journal of Health Professions Education*, 16(2), e1143.

Yu TW, Titus S, Rowe M, Frantz J. (2023). Health science educators' perception of using and applying virtual reality in the curriculum. *MedEdPublish*.

Yu TW, Achmat G, Kock L, Smithdorf G. (2021). Exercise therapy education enriched through interprofessional teaching. *Medical Education*.

Yu TW, Ennion L. (2019). Participation restrictions and vocational rehabilitation needs experienced by persons with a unilateral lower limb amputation in the Western Cape, South Africa. *African Journal of Disability*, 8, 456.

Research focus: technology-enhanced higher education; health professions education; responsible AI and clinical reasoning; immersive VR/XR; simulation-based education; assessment and curriculum design; implementation and quality enhancement.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS & EXTERNAL DISSEMINATION

30 July 2026 - Speaker and Panel Chair, International Postgraduate Conference and Research Forum, The Education University of Hong Kong: "From Novelty to Curriculum Integration: A Practical Toolkit for Implementing Virtual Reality in Health Professions Education."

14 September 2026 - Invited Learning and Teaching Presentation: "Transforming Physiotherapy Education with the use of AI, VR and Simulation."

28 August 2026 - Invited Clinical Educator Training Programme: "Transforming Physiotherapy Education through Innovative Teaching Pedagogies."

2023 - World Physiotherapy Congress, Dubai: short communication on health professions students' perceptions of VR.

2023 - AMEE, Scotland: short communication on educators' perceptions of VR in health professions education.

2023 - British Chinese Language Teaching Society Annual International Conference, Edinburgh: platform presentation on VR-enhanced language learning.

2022 - Southern African Association of Health Educationalists: "Heading back to the classroom: Virtual Reality and Other Learning Technologies."

SUPERVISION, SERVICE & PROFESSIONAL ENGAGEMENT

Honours research project supervision and research-methodology support for undergraduate physiotherapy students.

Internal moderation and assessment quality-assurance leadership within the BSc Physiotherapy programme.

Programme planning, student mentorship, clinical-education support, admissions/outreach and teaching/assessment coordination.

Participation in peer review, internal research/ethics review and collaborative health professions education projects.

Member, South African Society of Physiotherapy (Research subgroup); Co-operation member, Hong Kong Physiotherapists' Union.

LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY

English - Fluent professional proficiency across speaking, listening, reading and writing.

Cantonese - Fluent speaking and listening; limited reading and writing.

Putonghua (Mandarin) - Fluent speaking and listening; limited reading and writing.

SCHOLARSHIP

Selected publications and project records: Research and publications.

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